LETTERS CONFLICT

Book One · Origins — The Anatomy of the Conflict

Book Blueprint and Production Plan

Najuna Saviour · KandaNews Africa Co. Ltd

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How to use this document

This blueprint is the single reference for writing, designing and publishing *Letters Conflict: Origins*. Where earlier planning documents disagree with it, this document wins. It replaces the four competing Origins chapter lists produced during earlier planning, and it applies the house format of *The Japanese Way* (KandaNews Africa, 2026) so that both books sit together on a shelf as the work of one author and one publisher.

Items marked **[Author]** need Najuna Saviour's input or approval. Items marked **[Verify]** are research leads that must be checked against the original source before they appear in the manuscript.

1. Series decisions locked for all three books

Decision	Locked value
Series title	Letters Conflict (no apostrophe). The typing app, which currently uses "Letter's Conflict", should align. [Author]
Byline and publisher	Najuna Saviour · KandaNews Africa Co. Ltd · www.kandanews.africa
Book titles	Book One: Origins — The Anatomy of the Conflict Book Two: Somewhere in Africa — The Anatomy of Our Contradictions Book Three: Africa Adjustment Bureau — The Architecture of a New Africa
Central metaphor	People are the letters. Institutions are the grammar. Shared progress is the sentence. (The longer ladder — community as word, nation as conversation — may appear once, in Book Three, and nowhere else.)
The metaphor's limits	A person keeps their dignity when an institution fails or overlooks them. No ruler or reformer is entitled to arrange people as passive letters. Alignment never means sameness: "AFRICA" needs different letters.
Trilogy movement	Formation → Manifestation → Adjustment How did we get here? → What are we doing now? → What must we build?
Genre	Literary-philosophical nonfiction: lyrical in voice, disciplined in evidence.
Format	6 × 9 in paperback and Kindle; EB Garamond; house layout of The Japanese Way.

2. What this book is for

The reader

Primary reader: a young African adult, roughly 18 to 35 — a university student, graduate, young professional or entrepreneur — who loves the continent, is frustrated by much of what they see, and has never been given a coherent account of how the present came to be. [Author: confirm]

Secondary readers: the African diaspora; teachers and lecturers; civil servants, church and community leaders, and policymakers who want a readable synthesis.

The promise

> *This book will show you what African societies built, what broke them, what they inherited, and what Africans themselves chose — so that you can stop choosing between shame and nostalgia, and start understanding.*

The change in the reader

When they open the book, the reader may believe...	When they close it, the reader should understand...
Africa was "dark" and had no real civilisation before Europe.	African societies built states, cities, scholarship, law and trade — documented by archaeology and manuscripts.
Africa was a golden paradise until outsiders destroyed it.	Those societies also had hierarchy, slavery, war and failure. Greatness and injustice coexisted.
Everything wrong today is colonialism's fault.	Slave trades, conquest and colonial institutions changed trajectories profoundly — and Africans made consequential choices before, during and after them.
Everything wrong today is Africans' fault.	Present conditions emerged from interacting layers of history, not from any inherent inadequacy of African people.
History is a list of grievances or a source of pride.	History explains the arrangement we inherited. It does not decide the arrangement we must keep.

The emotional journey

Wonder → complexity → fracture → inheritance → responsibility. Each Part of the book carries one or two of these movements (see Section 3).

The last sentence, and the hand-off to Book Two

> *History placed some letters badly. But history is no longer holding every hand. So why are we still writing some of the same sentences?*

3. The shape of the book

Origins follows the house structure of *The Japanese Way*: front matter, a personal Introduction, three Parts, an Appendix, Research Notes and Sources, and About the Author. The planned length is about **60,000 words** (around 270 printed pages at the house layout). That is twice the length of *The Japanese Way* — substantial enough for a history, still readable for the primary reader.

Section	Contents	Words
Front matter	Title page · Copyright · Dedication [Author] · Acknowledgments [Author] · Contents · A Note to the Reader	1,000
Introduction	The Book I Started on Campus — the author's origin story, the belief research corrected, and the question the book follows. Built from the author interview. [Author]	2,500
Part I	What Was Built — wonder and complexity (Chapters 1–5)	27,000
Part II	What Was Broken — fracture (Chapters 6–7)	12,000
Part III	What Was Inherited — inheritance and responsibility (Chapters 8–11)	18,500
Back matter	Appendix (timeline, glossary, maps list) · Research Notes and Sources · About the Author · Also by Najuna Saviour · Coming next: Somewhere in Africa	outside count

The eleven chapters

Earlier plans fixed ten chapters. This blueprint restores an eleventh — *When Power Became Greater Than Purpose* — because the history of personalised power after independence was one of the author's founding themes and had been squeezed out of Origins. Book Two can show how that behaviour feels today; only Origins can explain where it came from.

#	Chapter	The job it does for the reader	Signature story [Verify]	Words
	PART I · WHAT WAS BUILT			
1	The Story Before the Wound	Shows who wrote Africa out of history and who wrote it back in; sets the book's rules of evidence through story, not lecture.	A century of argument over who built Great Zimbabwe (1871–1970s); Hegel and Trevor-Roper versus Dike, Ki-Zerbo and UNESCO's General History of Africa.	5,000
2	Nile, Kush, and the Horn	Establishes deep, documented state-building in north-east Africa — and who carried its costs.	Queen Amanirenas of Kush, the war with Rome and the bronze head of Augustus buried beneath a temple step at Meroë. Ezana of Aksum and his coins. The Egypt debate (Cheikh Anta Diop) addressed directly.	5,500
3	Gold, Manuscripts, and the Cities of Knowledge	Connects Sahelian scholarship to the commerce and institutions that sustained it, including slavery within that order.	Mansa Musa's passage through Cairo (1324). The Timbuktu manuscripts and their evacuation during the 2012–13 occupation.	5,500

#	Chapter	The job it does for the reader	Signature story [Verify]	Words
4	Stone, Sea, and Bronze	Widens "civilisation" to southern Africa, the Swahili coast and Ife/Benin — builders, merchants, artisans.	Ibn Battuta at Kilwa (1331). Mapungubwe's golden rhinoceros. The Ife heads. Great Zimbabwe's economy (not its authorship — that belongs to Chapter 1).	5,500
5	The Grammar of African Power	Compares how centralised and decentralised societies distributed authority, land and accountability.	The Great Lakes kingdoms — Buganda's Kabaka and Lukiiko, Bunyoro-Kitara, Kooki [Author]. The Igbo saying "Igbo enwe eze". Ecology and the tsetse fly.	5,500
	PART II · WHAT WAS BROKEN			
6	The Markets of Captivity	Explains several slave trades, African and external actors, resistance, and the long-run damage to trust.	King Afonso I of Kongo's 1526 letters to the King of Portugal — literally letters in conflict. Nunn and Wantchekon on trust.	6,000
7	Lines Drawn Across Living Worlds	Moves beyond the map: how conquest changed authority, labour, tax and land in particular places.	The 1900 Buganda Agreement, mailo land and Buganda agents in other regions. Yaa Asantewaa's war (1900). Berlin (1884–85) and partitioned homelands.	6,000
	PART III · WHAT WAS INHERITED			
8	Freedom with Inherited Machinery	Separates inherited constraints from African decisions at independence.	Uganda 1962–67: independence, the 1966 crisis and the abolition of the kingdoms; restoration in 1993. Comparison with Ghana 1957.	5,000
9	When Power Became Greater Than Purpose	Traces one-party states, coups, Cold War patrons and structural adjustment — and the counter-example of institutional continuity.	The coups of the 1960s and 1970s; Cold War patronage; Botswana as a complication that defeats simple explanations.	5,000
10	When Greatness Began to Sound Like a Fairy Tale	Explains how documented achievement became distant: schooling, museums, language, looted heritage.	The 1897 removal of the Benin Bronzes and the returns of the 2020s. Ngũgĩ wa Thiong'o on language. What Ugandan classrooms taught. [Author]	4,500
11	The Sentence We Inherited	Brings the layers together without one villain or one century; hands the reader to Book Two.	Returns to the wall of Chapter 1 and to the author's campus question.	4,000

What each chapter owns

To stop the same material appearing three times, each recurring subject has one owner. Other chapters may mention it in a sentence and point forward or back.

Subject	Owner	Others may only…
Great Zimbabwe: who built it, and the argument about it	Ch 1	Ch 4 covers its economy; Ch 10 refers back
Great Zimbabwe: economy and society	Ch 4	
Historical method (sources, oral tradition)	A Note to the Reader + Ch 1 (in story form)	Use one-line reminders
Slavery inside African societies	Ch 3 and Ch 5 (in context)	Ch 6 handles the external trades
Colonial education and memory	Ch 10	Ch 7 mentions mission schools briefly
Personalised power after independence	Ch 9	Book Two dramatises the present-day form
Great Lakes kingdoms and Uganda	Ch 5 (before), Ch 7 (conquest), Ch 8 (independence)	A deliberate thread through the book

4. The house chapter format

Every chapter follows the layout of *The Japanese Way*, adapted for history. The order inside the chapter can bend; the elements cannot be skipped.

1. **Chapter number and title**, then an **epigraph** — preferably an African voice, with a verified source.
2. **The opening scene** — a documented moment with named people, place and date. Never a hypothetical.
3. **The governing question** — stated plainly within the first two pages.
4. **The history** — two or three cases told in enough depth to feel real, under bold section headings.
5. **The mechanism** — how authority, incentives, knowledge, trade or force shaped relationships.
6. **"When the evidence corrects the story"** — the house move from *The Japanese Way*: a popular belief, checked, and found more complicated.
7. **The Letter Principle** — a short philosophical paragraph the chapter has earned. It replaces "Final Reflection".
8. **Questions for Reflection** — four or five questions for students, book clubs and classrooms. They replace "Action Steps".
9. **The closing line** — every chapter ends on the series refrain or a variation of it: *The letters remain. The question is the sentence.*

Citations appear in the text as [n] and are numbered through the whole book, exactly as in *The Japanese Way*. Each note says what the source supports and what it does not.

5. Front and back matter

Page	Content
Title page	LETTERS CONFLICT · ORIGINS · The Anatomy of the Conflict · Book One · Najuna Saviour · First Edition, 2027
Copyright	House wording from The Japanese Way, plus: "Historical claims are supported by the Research Notes and Sources. Reconstructed scenes and illustrations are identified in the text." ISBN lines for paperback and ebook.
Dedication	[Author]
Acknowledgments	[Author] — include any historians, elders or readers who review the manuscript.
A Note to the Reader	One page: how the book separates established history, scholarly debate, oral tradition and the author's interpretation. This is where the method lives, so the chapters can tell stories.
Introduction	The Book I Started on Campus. [Author interview]
Appendix	A. Timeline of the societies and events in the book. B. Glossary. C. List of maps.
Research Notes and Sources	Book-wide numbered notes, annotated in the house style.
About the Author	House wording, extended to mention The Japanese Way and the trilogy.
Series pages	"Also by Najuna Saviour" and "Coming next: Somewhere in Africa", with a short excerpt.

6. Voice and evidence rules

- Lyrical at the entrances and exits of chapters; clear, concrete and confident in the middle. Rigour belongs in the notes and the Note to the Reader, not in constant qualification of the prose.
- Name people, places and dates. Prefer one real person to three hypothetical ones.
- Never invent quotations, dialogue or private thoughts for real people. Label any reconstruction.
- Never treat "Africa" as one character. Name the society, region and century.
- Hold structure and agency together: outsiders' actions and Africans' choices both appear.
- Every statistic carries its source, year and coverage.
- The author appears as "I" in the Introduction, at the end of Part openings where useful, and in Chapter 11. Elsewhere the voice is the author's, but the subject is the history.
- The author's own words and judgement shape every chapter. The manuscript is written with research and editorial assistance, but its arguments, experiences and final wording are approved by the author. [Author]

7. Cover brief

The idea

Fragments before understanding. Letterforms carved into, or emerging from, coursed dry stone and red laterite earth — some whole, some broken, some half-buried. The image asks: *who were these letters before the sentence broke?* It should be original artwork. No continent silhouettes, raised fists, acacia trees, generic tribal borders, or photographs of real people.

Starting point: the original covers already created for the trilogy — Origins as an earthy, archaeological scene of a figure standing before a landscape of scattered letters; Somewhere in Africa as streets, people and everyday disorder; Africa Adjustment Bureau as thinkers, blueprints and a transformed city — together with the box-set mockup. This brief refines those designs rather than replacing them. [Author: send the cover files]

The trilogy images currently shown on the series web page belong to other authors' books (*The Last Word*, *Dream of Africa*, *Exode 2050*) and must be replaced with the original covers before any public use.

Trilogy system

	Origins	Somewhere in Africa	Africa Adjustment Bureau
Idea	Fragments — letters in stone and soil	Collision — letters in streets, forms, queues	Alignment — letters in a grid, still different
Palette	Laterite red, ochre, granite grey, bone	Asphalt, signal amber, faded paint	Blueprint navy, white, one gold accent
Texture	Stone, earth, manuscript	Concrete, paper, metal	Grid, drafting paper, glass

Shared across all three: one series wordmark (LETTERS CONFLICT, tracked capitals), the same title position, author name at the foot, and a spine system in which the three spines placed side by side complete a single large letterform that no one spine contains.

Front, spine and back

- **Front:** LETTERS CONFLICT (series wordmark) · ORIGINS · The Anatomy of the Conflict · BOOK ONE · NAJUNA SAVIOUR.
- **Spine:** LETTERS CONFLICT · ORIGINS · NAJUNA SAVIOUR · KandaNews mark · the spine fragment of the trilogy letterform.
- **Back (mirroring The Japanese Way):** headline, blurb, author photo and short bio, publisher block, barcode area.

Draft back-cover copy

AFRICA WAS NEVER AN EMPTY PAGE.

Series tagline (from earlier work): "We are all letters—waiting to make meaning. But what happens when we never align?"

Before the borders, there were kingdoms. Before the maps, there were journeys. Stone cities rose in the south, scholars copied manuscripts in the Sahel, and queens of Kush made war on Rome.

So how did societies that built so much arrive at a present in which so many institutions struggle to turn talent into shared progress — and in which their own achievements can sound like fairy tales?

In *Origins*, the first book of the Letters Conflict trilogy, Najuna Saviour follows that question through the evidence: the civilisations Africans built and the injustices within them, the slave trades and the conquest that broke them, and the machinery inherited at independence — along with the choices Africans made with it. Refusing both colonial caricature and romantic myth, he offers something harder and more useful: an explanation.

History explains the arrangement we inherited. It does not decide the arrangement we must keep.

Interior specification (Amazon KDP)

Item	Specification
Trim	6 × 9 in, matching The Japanese Way. (An earlier recommendation of 5.5 × 8.5 in would add about 50 pages at the same length.) [Author: confirm]
Margins	Mirrored margins: inside 0.75 in, outside 0.6 in, top and bottom 0.75 in. KDP minimum inside margin is 0.5 in for 151–300 pages and 0.625 in for 301–500 pages.
Body text	EB Garamond 11 pt, justified, about 1.25 line spacing; first-line indent of 0.25 in and no space between paragraphs; no indent after a heading.
Chapter openings	Every chapter starts on a right-hand page, with no running header on its first page.
Running headers	Book title on left-hand pages, chapter number on right-hand pages.
Front matter	Title, copyright and dedication pages carry no page numbers; Note to the Reader and Contents use Roman numerals.
Files	Paperback: print-ready PDF with fonts embedded. Kindle: EPUB built from the same manuscript.

Cover specifications (Amazon KDP)

Item	Specification
Trim	6 × 9 in, matching The Japanese Way
Bleed	0.125 in on every outside edge of the full cover
Spine width	Page count × 0.0025 in (cream paper) or × 0.002252 in (white). At about 270 pages on cream: about 0.68 in. Spine text needs at least 79 pages.
Full cover size	0.125 + 6 + spine + 6 + 0.125 in wide × 9.25 in high (about 12.93 × 9.25 in at 270 cream pages)
Final spine	Calculated only after typesetting, from the real page count
Barcode	Leave a clear area on the lower back cover for the ISBN barcode

8. Production plan

Working targets, not deadlines. They assume one chapter drafted and reviewed per week, and a single release of all three books.

Stage	What happens	Target
1. Blueprint	This document approved or corrected by the author. [Author]	This week
2. Proof of voice	Chapter 1 rebuilt in house format; author reviews voice and format before more is written.	This week
3. Author interview	Author answers 14 questions; the Introduction is drafted from his own words.	Early November 2026
4. Chapters 2–11	Research dossier then chapter, one per week, each reviewed by the author.	Nov 2026 – Jan 2027
4b. Books Two and Three	Blueprints, then drafting of Somewhere in Africa and Africa Adjustment Bureau.	Feb – May 2027
5. Front cover concept	Original artwork direction and front cover for approval.	November 2026
6. Specialist read	A historian (ideally at Makerere University) reviews the factual chapters of Origins.	February 2027
7. Edit and fact check	Full fact check and line edit of all three books; notes and appendices completed.	June 2027
8. Typesetting and full covers	House layout, final page counts, spines calculated, three full wrap covers and box-set artwork.	July 2027
9. Proof and release	Printed proofs, corrections, KDP series page, and release of all three books together, as the author intends.	August–September 2027

9. What carries forward to Books Two and Three

- Each later book gets its own blueprint in this format before drafting begins.
- **Somewhere in Africa** keeps its final ten-chapter list but must state in its Note to the Reader which scenes are witnessed, composite or invented. Every scene has an evidence bank behind it.
- **Africa Adjustment Bureau** chooses one chapter scheme (the final architecture's list) and keeps the Bureau as a framing device; each chapter answers: what principle, what failure it prevents, what institution carries it, what incentive keeps it working, how a citizen would know it works.
- Recurring images migrate across the books: the wall (Origins), the pothole (Somewhere), the case file (Bureau).